

Public

Ref: FOI/25/253

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Dear requester

Request for Information

Thank you for your request for information which was received by NESO on 19 January 2026.

Your request has been considered under the Environmental Information Regulations 2004 (EIR). This is because information about connection agreements relates to a measure that could affect the environment and therefore meets the definition of 'environmental information' provided at Regulation 2(1)(c) of the EIR.

Request

You asked us:

I would kindly request data on the current grid connection queue status regarding demand projects:

What is the capacity volume currently in the queue from... [expressed in GW]

1. Data centres?

- * xx GW - preliminary (low) /*
- * xx GW - under review or permitting (mid) /*
- * xx GW - late stage (high chance of realisation)*

1. Other demand?

- * xx GW - preliminary (low) /*
- * xx GW - under review or permitting (mid) /*
- * xx GW - late stage (high chance of realisation)*

Our response

We can confirm that we hold some recorded information in scope of your request.

NESO, in collaboration with the networks, industry, government and Ofgem has delivered a transformational change to the way that the grid connections process operates.

Information on Connections Reform is available here:

- [Connections Reform | National Energy System Operator.](#)
- [About Connections Reform | National Energy System Operator](#)

A key part of this reform is the introduction of the new Gate 2 to Whole Queue (G2TWQ) process, which ensures that only projects that are ready to go and are aligned to the [UK Government's Clean Power Action Plan](#) progress through to the new connections delivery pipeline.

The Gate 2 Criteria Methodology and Connections Network Design Methodology can be found here:

- [Connections Reform design documents and methodologies.](#)

On 8 December 2025 NESO published the results of the new connections delivery pipeline. Further detailed results data was published in January 2026:

- [Connections Reform Results | National Energy System Operator.](#)
- [Connections Reform: Detailed Results Data](#)

The published information provides a high-level view of the reformed pipeline. Further aggregated information on the new connections pipeline will be made available over the coming weeks and months.

Based on NESO's current Connections Reform and queue outcome datasets, we can provide an approximate aggregated total of 20 GW of "Transmission Connected Demand" in the connection queue.

Unfortunately, we are not able to provide any further breakdowns of this figure into 'Data Centre vs Other Demand Types', or Project Maturity Stages (e.g. early, mid, late stage), because demand-side technology classifications are not currently maintained within the existing queue or connection outcome data sets. This level of categorisation is part of NESO's Strategic Demand Initiative, which is still in development in collaboration with Ofgem, the Department of Energy Security and Net Zero and networks, and therefore not reflected in operational data sets. As a

result, GW numbers may fluctuate substantially when 'Demand' categorisation work is completed and technology labels are reassigned or updated.

In summary, we can only provide a high-level indicative total of approximately 20 GW for projects currently assigned under "Transmission Connected Demand". We cannot provide technology specific or maturity-based segmentation as this information is not held in NESO's current data sets.

This concludes our response to your request.

Advice and assistance

NESO's role to move electricity safely, reliably and efficiently through the electricity system. We don't generate or sell electricity and we're not responsible for the infrastructure needed to move electricity around. NESO Connections team is responsible for leading and facilitating the process by which customers connect to and make use of the transmission system. Further information about NESO's role in Connections is available here: [NESO's role in Connections | National Energy System Operator](#)

For information, NESO publishes the TEC Register twice weekly. The TEC Register is a current list of projects that hold contracts for Transmission Entry Capacity (TEC) with NESO, including existing and future connection projects and projects that can be directly connected to the National Electricity Transmission System (NETS), or make use of it. The current TEC Register is available on the NESO website: [Transmission Entry Capacity \(TEC\) register | National Energy System Operator](#). The TEC Register only covers connections to the transmission network. Some generation projects, particularly smaller projects, are contracted by Distribution Network Operators (DNO). Demand-only connections on the transmission system are not shown in the TEC Register.

We do not currently maintain a single register of demand connections. We are not required under the Connection and Use of System Code (CUSC) to maintain or publish one in the way that we are for generation connections. We have previously had enquiries about providing a demand register and are considering this as a development piece, but it would take some considerable time to produce.

Next steps

If you are dissatisfied with our handling of your FOI/EIR request, you can ask us to review our response. If you want us to carry out a review, please let us know within 40 working days and quote the reference number at the top of this letter. You can find our procedure here: [Freedom of Information and Environmental Information Regulations | National Energy System Operator](#).

The ICO's website also provides guidance on the internal review process: [What to do if you are dissatisfied with the response | ICO](#).

If you are still dissatisfied after our internal review, you can complain to the Information Commissioner's Office (ICO). You should make complaints to the ICO within six weeks of receiving the outcome of an internal review. The easiest way to lodge a complaint is through their website: www.ico.org.uk/foicomplaints. Alternatively, they can be contacted at: Wycliffe House, Water Lane, Wilmslow, SK9 5AF.

Thank you for your interest in the work of the National Energy System Operator (NESO).

Regards,

The Information Rights Team, National Energy System Operator (NESO)